

spheres – shut out and inadequate. Now, though, there is a wealth of different ways to access financial information, and mainstream organizations are having to work hard to try and bring their communication strategy into the twenty-first century, a good twenty years too late.

So, these communities, on Facebook, Instagram and even TikTok, have grown into platforms for education and connection, which is an undoubtedly good thing. But the shame and judgement are still there. There are endless TikToks, Reels and carousel posts dictating exactly what it means to be ‘good with money’, what constitutes ‘good debt’ and ‘bad debt’, which leads me to wonder: when is the moralizing of money going to end? Who is one person to decide what it means to be ‘good with money’? It’s completely subjective, surely.

All that is achieved by narratives such as this is that people in need of guidance feel ashamed and alienated, and are therefore prevented from accessing the information that they need. It undermines people’s confidence, creating and perpetuating self-fulfilling prophecies about being ‘bad with money’. It creates a feeling of panic, followed by a knee-jerk reaction – which is, in my experience, very rarely the starting point for lasting and sustainable change. In reality, being ‘good with money’ means different things to different people – there’s no one-size-fits-all prescription. Not everybody needs to live by the same plan, because not everyone has the same goals in sight or resources at their disposal. No matter how much